

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

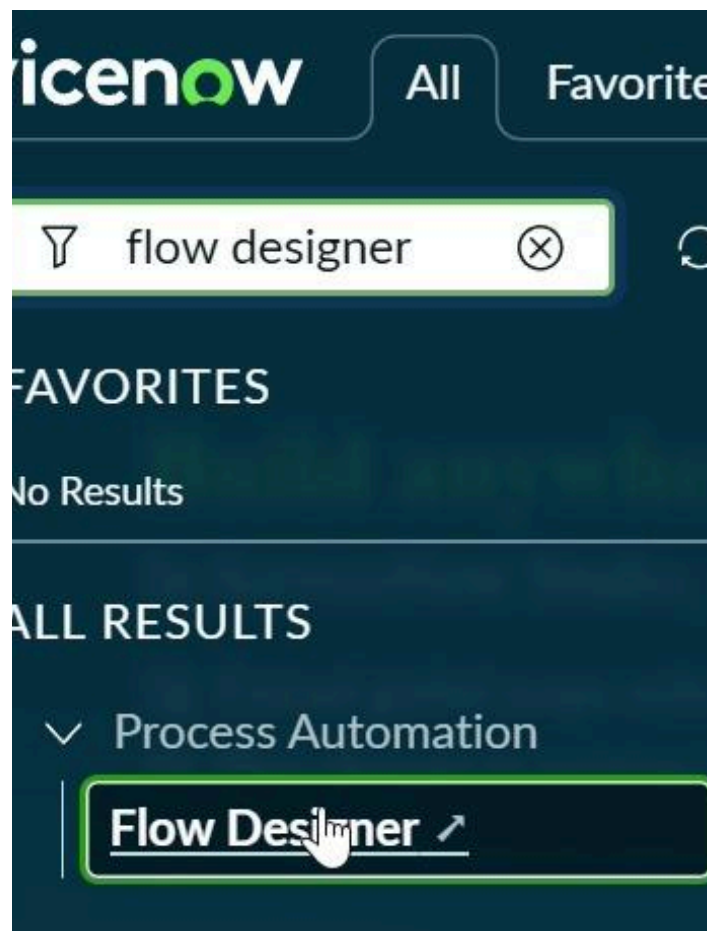
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



TRIGGER

 Add a trigger

ACTIONS [Select multiple](#)

 Add an Action, Flow Logic, or Subflow

ERROR HANDLER



If an error occurs in your flow, the actions you add here will run.

TRIGGER

 Service Catalog

Trigger



Advanced Options 

Delete

Cancel

Done

12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

ect multiple

Action

Flow Logic

Subflow

create catalog

INSTALLED SPOKES

ServiceNow Core

ITSM

NOT INSTALLED SPOKES

IntegrationHub

Service Catalog

Create Catalog Task

ACTIONS

Select multiple

1

Create Catalog Task

Action Properties

Action

Create Catalog Task

Action Inputs

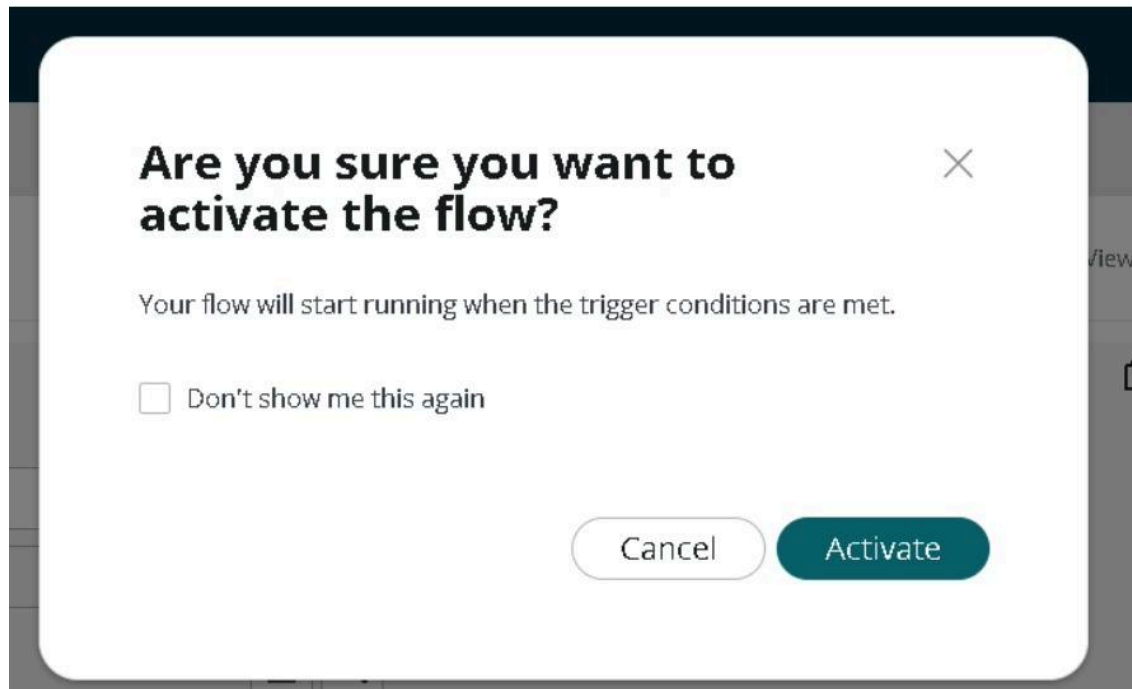
Table Name

Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]

Drag and drop Requested Item pill

Short Description



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Catalog Items

Name

Search

Actions on selected rows...

All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published Item is empty

☐	Q	Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
		3M Privacy Filter - Lenovo X1 Carbon	Privacy Filter - X1 Carbon	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$43.19	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
		3M Privacy Filter - MacBook Pro	Privacy Filter	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$42.23	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
		3M Privacy Filter - Macbook Pro Retina	Privacy Filter	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$40.31	Item	2022-11-20 16:00:00
		Access	Microsoft Access	true		Service Catalog	Software	\$139.99	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
		Acrobat	Adobe Acrobat	true		Service Catalog	Software	\$139.99	Item	2022-12-05 20:46:33
		Add network switch to datacenter cabinet	This standard change template describes ...	true		Service Catalog	Network Standard Changes	\$0.00	Item	2026-09-18 12:20:42
		Add/Remove users from group	Add/Remove users from group	true		Service Catalog	Services	\$0.00	Item	2022-12-05 10:17:33

is faster with the improved [Catalog Builder](#).

Name
 Application

Catalogs
 Active ☒

Category
 Roles

State
 Fulfillment automation level

Ed out

Owner

Owners

Engine
 Picture
 Pricing
 Portal Settings

Description

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number



- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Short description

Special instructions

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links
Show Work Flow
Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvals (1) Requiring Action (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for - 2 Q0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:37:12

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links
Workflow
Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvals (1) Requiring Action (1)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approval for - 2 Q0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:37:12

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Favorites History Workspaces Admin Requested Item - RITM0010001 Search

Requested Item RITM0010001 Discuss Follow Update Delete

Activities: 1

Impact: Low
Opened by: System Administrator
Priority: Low
State: Open

Update Delete

Related Links
Workflow Context

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvals Group approvals

Number Search Actions on selected rows... New

Requested Items - RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTAS-0010001	Hardware	(enprov)	Laptop needs to be configured	2024-04-17 04:11:43	(enprov)	

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section
13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. At the top, there are navigation buttons: Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The form is divided into two main sections. The left section contains fields for Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to (empty), Configuration item (empty), and an Active checkbox which is checked. The right section contains dropdown menus for Approval (Approved), Priority (Low), and State (Open). Below these are fields for Request item (7ITM0010001) and Requested for (System Administrator), each with a search icon. The bottom section has three text areas: Short description (Laptop needs to be Configured), Description (Laptop needs to be Configured), and Work notes (Work notes). A Post button is located at the bottom right of the Work notes field.

Number	SCTASK0010001	Approval	Approved
Assigned to		Priority	Low
Configuration item		State	Open
Active	☒	Request item	7ITM0010001
		Requested for	System Administrator
Short description	Laptop needs to be Configured		
Description	Laptop needs to be Configured		
Work notes	Work notes		

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.